

The Great American Timeline Challenge

30 picture cards • pre-1607 to 1963 • 8th Grade American Studies

How to run it: Cut the cards apart (one set per team of 3–4). Teams race to arrange all 30 events in chronological order — no phones, no notes, just arguing well. When a team locks in, check their order against the answer key. Scoring option: one point per card in the correct position relative to its neighbors. The cards are printed in scrambled order and coded with letters, so the sheet itself gives nothing away.

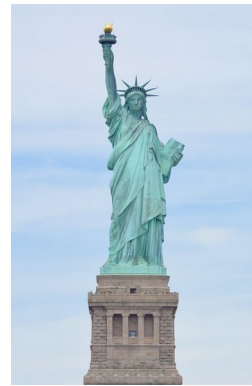
Week One version: use just 10–12 cards. Full deck returns as review during Units 4 and 8 — by June they can place all 30.

CARD A



Edison's practical light bulb

CARD B



The Statue of Liberty is dedicated

CARD C



The Trail of Tears

CARD D



The Declaration of Independence

CARD E



The Louisiana Purchase

CARD F



The Gettysburg Address

CARD G



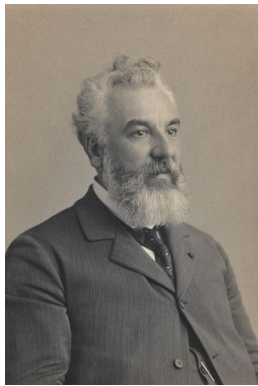
The Brooklyn Bridge opens

CARD H



The 19th Amendment — women win the vote

CARD J



Bell invents the telephone

CARD K



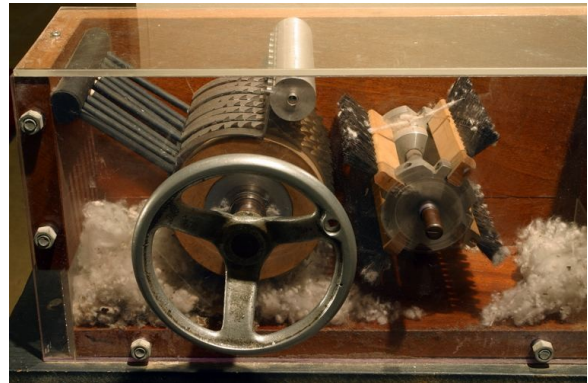
The Pony Express begins

CARD L



Ford's Model T debuts

CARD M



The cotton gin is invented

CARD N



The transcontinental railroad is completed

CARD P



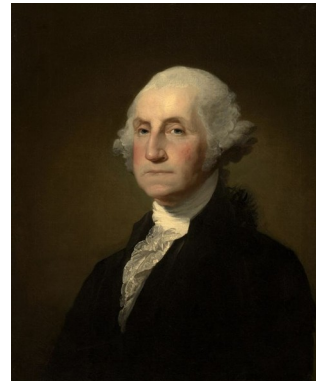
The Wright brothers' first flight

CARD Q



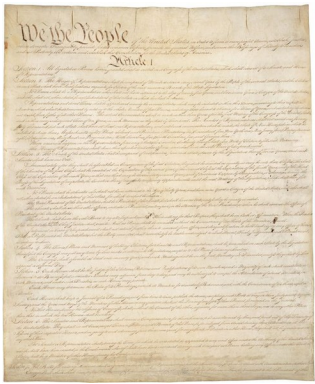
The Boston Tea Party

CARD R



Washington becomes the first president

CARD S



The U.S. Constitution is signed

CARD T



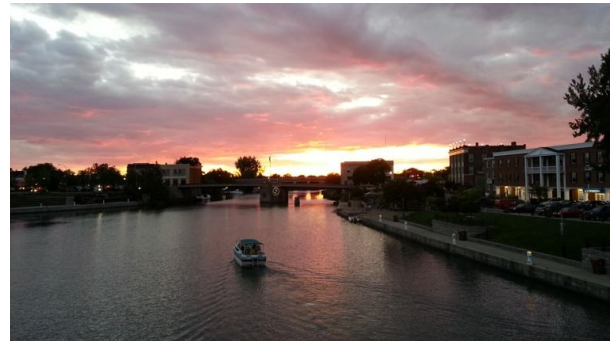
The Golden Gate Bridge opens

CARD U



Jamestown founded

CARD V



The Erie Canal opens

CARD W



The Mayflower lands at Plymouth

CARD X



Morse sends the first telegraph message

CARD Y



Brown v. Board of Education

CARD Z



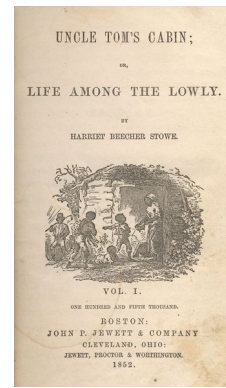
The March on Washington

CARD AA



The Empire State Building is completed

CARD BB



Uncle Tom's Cabin is published

CARD CC



The California Gold Rush

CARD DD



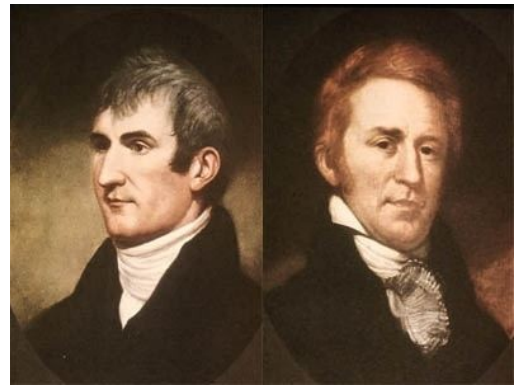
Ellis Island opens

CARD EE



The Emancipation Proclamation

CARD FF



Lewis & Clark head west

Answer Key — chronological order

#	Card	Year	Event
1	U	1607	Jamestown founded
2	W	1620	The Mayflower lands at Plymouth
3	Q	1773	The Boston Tea Party
4	D	1776	The Declaration of Independence
5	S	1787	The U.S. Constitution is signed
6	R	1789	Washington becomes the first president
7	M	1793	The cotton gin is invented
8	E	1803	The Louisiana Purchase
9	FF	1804	Lewis & Clark head west
10	V	1825	The Erie Canal opens
11	C	1838	The Trail of Tears
12	X	1844	Morse sends the first telegraph message
13	CC	1849	The California Gold Rush
14	BB	1852	Uncle Tom's Cabin is published
15	K	1860	The Pony Express begins
16	EE	1863	The Emancipation Proclamation
17	F	1863	The Gettysburg Address
18	N	1869	The transcontinental railroad is completed
19	J	1876	Bell invents the telephone
20	A	1879	Edison's practical light bulb
21	G	1883	The Brooklyn Bridge opens
22	B	1886	The Statue of Liberty is dedicated
23	DD	1892	Ellis Island opens
24	P	1903	The Wright brothers' first flight
25	L	1908	Ford's Model T debuts
26	H	1920	The 19th Amendment — women win the vote
27	AA	1931	The Empire State Building is completed
28	T	1937	The Golden Gate Bridge opens
29	Y	1954	Brown v. Board of Education
30	Z	1963	The March on Washington